

Poster Topic for Groups B3
Due by 28 FEB 2025 at 11.59 pm

Please produce a 500-word argumentative poster using the template provided responding to this question:

If sexist discrimination should be illegal, then sex-selective discrimination likewise should be illegal.

Do you agree with this statement? You may refer to specific countries and case studies in your response. Support your arguments with relevant examples. In presenting your arguments, refer at least one ethical theory or principle covered in this course.

The assessment criteria for the poster can be found in Appendix 1 of the CC0003 course outline.

You may use the research material from your panel discussion. However, the poster is an independent piece of work, so **you may not** discuss, co-plan, co-write or collude in any way with your panel team mates or anyone, to do this assignment. Collusion is academic dishonesty and students will be subject to penalties if found colluding or plagiarising. Please note the university's policy on academic dishonesty.

You may use GAI programs (e.g., ChatGPT, Grammarly etc.) **only** to help in your **poster assignment** such as to generate ideas and to improve your writing. However, you should be aware that the materials generated by GAI programs may contain inaccuracies and can be incomplete. Please be aware that the use of GAI may also stifle the development of your skills in *analytical and evaluative writing as well as in critical thinking*. **Please note that content from GAI programs, whether directly quoted from and/or paraphrased in your own words, must be properly and accordingly quoted and cited every time they are used**. Failure to do so is considered a violation of academic integrity. Please make proper declaration in the "Declaration of Academic Integrity" Form (attached in your poster assignment template) if you employ any GAI programs to help in your poster and submit this Form **together** with your poster.

How to submit your poster:

1. NTULearn 1. Go to the site of your CC0003 tutorial group: <https://ntulearn.ntu.edu.sg/>
2. Go to "Content" There you'll find a poster submission portal with the name **"Poster Submission for Groups B1"**.
3. Click on the submission portal. It will take you to a Turnitin website.
4. Follow the website's instructions for entering your information and uploading your poster. Please don't write your name anywhere in your poster. Instead, identify yourself by writing your matriculation number. This will allow your instructor to mark

posters without knowing the exact identity of the author. Your instructor will be able to identify you based on your matriculation number after they've finished grading.

Word count policy:

Your poster should not be more than 500 words long, **not counting** the title, footnotes, and bibliography. If the main text is more than 500 words long, your instructor will not read more than 500 words in the main text of the poster.

References & bibliography:

Your poster should include references and a bibliography. The APA referencing style must be used. Please see the template below for further instructions on referencing.

Late submission policy:

Extensions will be granted only for students with valid reasons for not submitting the poster by the deadline. Valid reasons include falling sick, a family tragedy, and special learning needs. All such requests for extensions must be supported by documentation, such as a medical certificate, a record of the family tragedy, or a letter from the NTU Accessible Education Unit.

There will be a grade penalty for students who submit their posters after the deadline without a valid reason. The penalty will be one half of a letter grade for every calendar day the poster is submitted after the due date (less than one day late will be counted as a full day late).

CC0003: ARGUMENTATIVE POSTER TEMPLATE

There are 5 boxes below. The one titled "Main Argument" is for you to present your main argument in response to the question. The one titled "Rebuttal" is for you to present a possible rebuttal to the main argument you presented. The final one, titled "Counter-Argument" is for you to present a counter-argument to the rebuttal that will serve to defend your initial position (main argument) against the rebuttal. There are two sections at the end: one called "Poster Citations" for you to cite the sources (eg: quotes/examples/ideas/arguments etc) you have used **in** the poster and the other, called a "Bibliography" to cite **all** the materials you have used and consulted. **Please use the APA style for referencing.** Please begin by filling in your matric number, tutorial class and the question you have chosen:

MATRIC NO:

TUTORIAL CLASS:

QUESTION: If sexist discrimination should be illegal, then sex-selective discrimination likewise should be illegal. Do you agree with this statement? You may refer to specific countries and case studies in your response. Support your arguments with relevant examples. In presenting your arguments, refer to at least one ethical theory or principle covered in this course.

MAIN ARGUMENT:

I agree that if sexist discrimination is illegal, then sex-selective discrimination should also be illegal. Sex-selective abortion is a form of gender discrimination because it ends a pregnancy based on the sex of the foetus. This practice treats the unborn child as a tool to fulfil personal, cultural, or economic preferences rather than recognising the child as a human being with inherent worth. In countries like India and China, sex-selective abortions have led to a large imbalance between boys and girls. Such an imbalance creates serious social problems — for example, many men remain unmarried, which can lead to increased human trafficking and social instability.

From a Kantian perspective, every human being has inherent dignity and must be treated as an end in themselves, not as a means to an end. If we believe that sexist discrimination is wrong because it devalues a person based on their sex, then choosing to abort a foetus because it is not of the preferred gender is equally wrong. This practice sends the message that one gender is less valuable than the other. Therefore, if we are to protect individual rights and promote a fair society, sex-selective abortion must be illegal.

REBUTTAL:

Some people argue from a virtue ethics standpoint that parents should be free to shape their families as they see fit. They claim that if parents believe having a child of a particular gender will bring happiness and harmony to their home — especially in cultures where having a son or a daughter is linked to economic security or social status — then they should be allowed to choose. They warn that banning sex-selective abortion can push the practice underground. For example, in India, the PCPNDT Act was introduced to stop sex determination, yet illegal abortions and female infanticide continued, leading to unsafe practices and further imbalances. In their view, legalising sex selection would provide a safe, regulated way for parents to make this choice without risking their health or turning to dangerous methods.

COUNTER-ARGUMENT:

However, legalising sex-selective abortion risks normalising and deepening gender biases. Even if some families feel that choosing a child's sex improves their family life, it sends a broader message that one gender is less valuable than the other. The long-term effects can be devastating, as shown by the persistent gender imbalances in India and China. These imbalances, which result in phenomena like "missing women," contribute to social instability and reinforce discrimination against women.

Instead of allowing sex selection to meet personal or cultural preferences, the focus should be on changing the underlying social and cultural attitudes that devalue one gender. This can be achieved through education, economic reforms, and government policies that promote gender equality. From a Kantian point of view, every human being deserves equal respect, and legalising a practice that favours one gender over the other violates that principle. Protecting the dignity of every child means ensuring that all children are valued equally, regardless of their sex. Tackling the root causes of gender bias will lead to a fairer and more harmonious society.

POSTER CITATIONS:*(To cite material you've used/adapted/paraphrased (eg: quotes, statistics, arguments, concepts, content generated by GAI etc) in any of the above boxes (Main argument, Rebuttal, Counter-Argument) please label the material you've cited/used/adapted by numbering them (1), (2), (3) etc at the end of the relevant sentences. Then please label the corresponding citation **here** in the "Poster Citation" box with the same number (1), (2), (3) etc before you list the reference. This is so we know exactly which material you're referring to. Please use the APA style format.)*

Eg:

If in the Main Argument box a student writes this: In his paper Rachels writes, "To many thinkers, this observation—"Different cultures have different moral codes"—has seemed to be the key to understanding morality."⁽¹⁾

Then in the Poster Citation box the student should type this: (1) Rachels, 1999, p.16

Then in the Bibliography box, the student should type this: Rachels, J. (1999) *The Challenge of Cultural Relativism* in *The Elements of Moral Philosophy*. McGraw-Hill. (The use of italics in this particular reference follows the APA convention.)

Eg - Similarly, to cite content generated by GAI:

If in the Main Argument box a student writes this: The myriad of social norms around the world means that "morality in a given society is predicated on prevailing social norms."⁽¹⁾

Then in the Poster Citation box the student should type this: (1) [insert name of GAI, for e.g., ChatGPT], 2023

Then in the Bibliography box, the student should type this: [insert name of GAI]. (2023) [*type in the prompt used to generate the content being cited in your poster*] (The use of italics in this particular reference follows the APA convention.)

- (1) Kant, I. (1785). *Groundwork of the Metaphysics of Morals*. Retrieved from <https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/kant-moral/> (n.p.)
- (2) Hesketh, T., & Xing, Z. W. (2006). Abnormal sex ratios in human populations: Causes and consequences. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 103(36), 13271–13275. Retrieved from <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC3168620/>
- (3) Council of Europe Commissioner for Human Rights. (2011). Sex-selective abortions are discriminatory and should be banned. Retrieved from <https://www.coe.int/en/web/commissioner/-/sex-selective-abortion-are-discriminatory-and-should-be-banned-1> (n.p.)
- (4) Wikipedia. (2023). *Pre-Conception and Pre-Natal Diagnostic Techniques Act, 1994*. Retrieved from https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pre-Conception_and_Pre-Natal_Diagnostic_Techniques_Act,_1994 (n.p.)
- (5) Wikipedia. (2023). *One-child policy*. Retrieved from https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/One-child_policy (n.p.)

BIBLIOGRAPHY:

(Should be ordered alphabetically)

Council of Europe Commissioner for Human Rights. (2011). *Sex-selective abortions are discriminatory and should be banned*. Retrieved from <https://www.coe.int/en/web/commissioner/-/sex-selective-abortion-are-discriminatory-and-should-be-banned-1>

Hesketh, T., & Xing, Z. W. (2006). Abnormal sex ratios in human populations: Causes and consequences. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 103(36), 13271–13275. Retrieved from <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC3168620/>

Kant, I. (1785). *Groundwork of the Metaphysics of Morals*. Retrieved from <https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/kant-moral/>

Wikipedia. (2023). *One-child policy*. Retrieved from https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/One-child_policy

Wikipedia. (2023). *Pre-Conception and Pre-Natal Diagnostic Techniques Act, 1994*. Retrieved from https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pre-Conception_and_Pre-Natal_Diagnostic_Techniques_Act,_1994

CC0003 declaration of academic integrity:

Declaration of Academic Integrity

Please fill in the required information and sign to indicate that you have read and accepted the following statements. Your poster assignment will not be accepted without this declaration.

By listing my name and signing below, I confirm that:

1. I have read and understood the [University Code of Conduct](#), including the information on practices concerning [academic integrity](#) and that in the attached poster submission, I have worked within its expectations.
2. I have read and understood the assessment criteria for argumentative poster (Appendix 1) and that in the attached poster submission, I have worked within its expectations.
3. I am aware that failure to act in accordance with the University Code of Conduct may lead to the imposition of penalties which may include the requirement to revise and resubmit an assignment, receiving a lower grade, or receiving an F grade for the assignment; suspension from the University or termination of my candidature.
4. I consent to the University copying and distributing any or all of my work in any form and using third parties to verify whether my work contains plagiarised material, and for quality assurance purposes.
5. I have uploaded the poster in the Turnitin portal for my small group on my tutorial site.

To check the following where applicable:

- ☐ I confirm that the submitted poster is substantively produced and completed by myself and I did not use any Generative Artificial Intelligence (GAI) programs (e.g., ChatGPT, etc.).
- ☒ I confirm that the submitted poster is substantively produced and completed by myself. However, I have used GAI programs in the following manner to complete the poster:
- ☐ To generate ideas, lines of argument, pieces of supporting evidence, and/or other similar uses (**I have cited the poster content generated by the GAI programs in accordance with the respective instructions as laid out in the poster assignment template**)
 - ☒ Others (**I have elaborated on our use of GAI programs using a separate document**)
– I had just use GAI to check my grammar. I write down all the idea and points I had into paragraphs in my own words. Then I ask GAI to check on the grammar and sentence structure.

Tutorial Group _____ Small Group _____

Name

Signature

Date